their business alone. If the waiter was rude or made a racist remark, you could make a scene and perhaps tell your friends not to go there, but few other people would hear about it.

Peer-to-peer surveillance networks have obliterated that sense of privacy. If the staff fails to please a customer, the restaurant will get a bad review, which could affect the decision of thousands of potential customers in coming years. For better or worse, the balance of power tilts in favour of the customers, while the staff find themselves more exposed than before to the public gaze. As the author and journalist Linda Kinstler put it, 'Before Tripadvisor, the customer was only nominally king. After, he became a veritable tyrant, with the power to make or break lives.'[46] The same loss of privacy is felt today by millions of taxi drivers, barbers, beauticians and other service providers. In the past, stepping into a taxi or barbers meant stepping into someone's private space. Now, when customers come into your taxi or barbers, they bring cameras, microphones, a surveillance network and thousands of potential viewers with them.[47] This is the foundation of a nongovernmental peer-to-peer surveillance network.

THE SOCIAL CREDIT SYSTEM

Peer-to-peer surveillance systems typically operate by aggregating many points to determine an overall score. Another type of surveillance network takes this 'score logic' to its ultimate conclusion. This is the social credit system, which seeks to give people points for *everything* and produce an overall personal score that will influence *everything*. The last time humans came up with such an ambitious points system was five thousand years ago in Mesopotamia, when money was invented. One way to think of the social credit system is as a new kind of money.

Money is points that people accumulate by selling certain products and services, and then use to buy other products and services. Some countries call their 'points' dollars, whereas other countries call them euros, yen or renminbi. The points can take the form of coins, banknotes or bits in a digital bank account. The points themselves are, of course, intrinsically worthless. You cannot eat coins or wear banknotes. Their value lies in the fact that they serve as accounting tokens that society uses to keep track of our individual scores.